

Nazareth : a Morality in
One Act : by Laurence
Housman

Samuel French: Publisher

28 -30 West Thirty-eighth Street : New York

LONDON

Samuel French, Ltd.

26 SOUTHAMPTON STREET, STRAND

PRICE TWENTY-FIVE CENTS

Nazareth : a Morality in
One Act : by Laurence
Housman

Samuel French: Publisher

28 -30 West Thirty-eighth Street : New York

LONDON

Samuel French, Ltd.

26 SOUTHAMPTON STREET, STRAND

PRICE TWENTY-FIVE CENTS

The Project Gutenberg eBook of Nazareth: a morality in one act

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: Nazareth: a morality in one act

Author: Laurence Housman

Release date: December 26, 2022 [eBook #69644]

Most recently updated: October 19, 2024

Language: English

Original publication: United States: Samuel French, Ltd., 1916

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/69644

Credits: Charlene Taylor, Carla Foust and the Online Distributed Proofreading Team at <https://www.pgdp.net> (This file was produced from images generously made available by The Internet Archive/American Libraries.)

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK NAZARETH: A
MORALITY IN ONE ACT ***

Nazareth: a Morality in One Act: by Laurence Housman

Samuel French: Publisher

28-30 West Thirty-eighth Street: New York

LONDON

Samuel French, Ltd.

26 SOUTHAMPTON STREET, STRAND

Copyright, 1916

By LAURENCE HOUSMAN

CAUTION.—Amateurs and Professionals are hereby warned that “NAZARETH,” being fully protected under the copyright laws of the United States, is subject to royalty, and any one presenting the play without the consent of the author or his authorized agent, will be liable to the penalties by law provided. Application for the right to produce “NAZARETH” must be made to Samuel French, 28-30 West 38th Street, New York City.

ALL RIGHTS RESERVED.

NAZARETH.

PROLOGUE.

Since Love first looked on life with human eyes,
Twixt him and us time like a curtain lies.
Of all the years while He made life His own
With dear familiar touch—how little's known!
The gospels of His Birth, the tale make plain
Then two years till He died and rose again,
Naught else remains to us of all, save when
He, at Jerusalem, with learned men
Was by His parents found, and taken thence
Back to far Nazareth. And by no sense
Of mortal mind from where they now lie hid
Can we recover the fair things He did,
Growing to man's estate, that He might die
For man's salvation; hidden there they lie,
The days which mounted up to Calvary.

Yet here on earth that lovely deed was done;
Love in man's form took life from wind and sun,
Waked, slept, ate bread, and toiled, and without speed,
Patient, made test of each frail weak human need;
Found means on small frail feet men's ways to go;
From mother tongue was taught man's speech to know;
So, for man's making, childhood, boyhood, youth,
Each he endowed in turn with deathless truth,
Himself the type and pattern for each stage
Of human growth. Oh! in what future age
Shall we who, seeking that lost Pattern, roam,
Find it again, and to that form come home?

Ah, friends! this simple showing that ye see
Of Love at Nazareth, this is not He!
'Tis but a thought, a fathering wish, a prayer
That with hearts knit we may come closelier there,

Where He lived lowly. Lo, He by your side
Lies hidden, a waiting guest, still multiplied
By man's still growing needs,—with such intent
He made humanity His Sacrament;
The flesh and blood, which here we beat and bruise,
Is Christ's. Ah, put it to some better use!
Be members all with all! Hear what Love saith,
And make your home with Him at Nazareth!

NAZARETH

SCENE:—*The Carpenter's shop is a low, broad chamber built of wood. At the back to the left-center a wide open doorway reveals a level stretch of landscape. It is late afternoon, but the air is still pale with the heat of day. To the right of the door is a small square window with wooden shutters thrown wide; before it stands a carpenter's bench upon which lies a wooden door frame nearly finished. The carpenter and his assistant are quietly at work planing, and boring holes for the fitting in of the rivets; beneath them the floor is strewn with shavings, saw-dust, and odds and ends of wood. Away to the left, near a spinning wheel, sits an aged woman combing flax. Against the wall to the same side of the doorway sits MARY, the carpenter's wife, with a book upon her knees; on the other side her son stands against the door-post, with his back to the interior, looking out into the sunshine.*

After the scene has opened the carpenter raises himself from a stooping position, and hands over to REUBEN, his assistant, a beam of wood, which the latter lays aside.

CARPENTER. 'Twill soon be done. Nay, we'll not need that now. Yes, speak on. If you read slowly enough, I can give heed.

MARY. (*Reading*). "Because his visage was so marred, many did marvel at him then, for more than most his form was scarred, yea, more than all the sons of men. Yet him shall all the nations hear, and kings shall shut their mouths for fear."

CARPENTER. (*To REUBEN*) Be careful, now the cross-beam's laid.

OLD ANNA. What cause have kings to be afraid?

MARY. (*Reading*) "Who hath believed our report? To whom is the Lord's arm revealed? He shall grow up in tender sort, and as a root from a dry field, having no form nor comeliness, that men who see should scorn him less."

CARPENTER. Hold it fast, now! Nay, don't let go.

MARY.—

“He is rejected and despised,
A man of sorrows, grief his lot,
He came to us unrecognized,
Despising, we esteemed him not.
Surely our sorrows he hath borne,
And for our sins hath felt the rod,
Wherefore he seemed a shape for scorn——
One smitten by the hand of God.
But he was wounded for our sins,
For our iniquities was scourged,
By chastisement our peace he wins,
And with his stripes mankind is purged.
All we like sheep have gone astray,
Turned everyone to his own way.
And upon him the Lord doth lay
The iniquity of all.”

(OLD ANNA *touches her daughter, and points toward the child.*)

MARY. (*After a pause, watching him*)

My son, what yonder dost thou see,
That holds thy gaze so steadfastly?
Come hither, child, and tell it me.

CHILD.—

I see the land all parched and dry,
And sheep, without a shepherd nigh,
And surely some look like to die.

ANNA. I see no sheep.

MARY.—

Nay, dearest one.
Thine eyes are dazzled by the sun;
See, in the field thy playmates run,
Wilt thou not join them?

CHILD.—

Mother, nay!
I will not go with them to-day.

ANNA. He never was a child for play.

CHILD. Mother, what were you reading then?

MARY.—

Isaiah's prophecy how men
Shall still be blind when God again
Comes to save Zion and redeem
His chosen ones.

CHILD. Was it a dream?

Or did he see? How did he know?

MARY. He heard God's word, and told men so.

CHILD. And was that many years ago?

MARY. Seven hundred years.

CHILD.—

But having here
His word to guide them, do men fear
They will not see Salvation near?

ANNA. Aye! many fear it. I for one.

CARPENTER. There, that's right! Now, 'tis almost done.

(The child turns towards the carpenter's bench.)

MARY. Thou will not miss that sight, my son.

CARPENTER.—

Come, little son, and hold the wood!
Brace hard the end, while I make good

The upright. See how crooked it stood!

CHILD. What art thou making, father?

CARPENTER.—

Nay,

See for thyself, my child, what way

One grows to wisdom day by day.

It is a door.

(REUBEN *goes and takes a cup, dips it in a bowl of water near the door and drinks.*)

CHILD. Whose door?

CARPENTER.

Why, mine,

Till I'm paid for it!

CHILD. How came it thine?

CARPENTER. I made it.

CHILD. How?

CARPENTER.—

Well, first I bought

The timber; after that I wrought,

Rough hewed and shaped it, leaving nought

To chance—so that all parts agree

When joined together. Dost thou see?

Art satisfied?

CHILD. (*After a pause*) Who made the tree?

CARPENTER. (*After a pause*) God made the tree, my son.

CHILD.—

And through

Long years it put forth leaf, and grew
In beauty till man came and slew.

(He caresses the wood, laying his face upon it)

CARPENTER. Strange fancies still!

CHILD.—

And so the tree
Died, and gave up its life to be
A door through which man passes free,
To work God's will.

CARPENTER.—

Come, come, you waste
Your father's time, my son! Make haste,
Reuben—we've got the lintel placed;
Bring me the nails.

REUBEN. *(As he brings the nails and drives them in. Sings)*

Oh, what is yon tree that stands so high
And stretches its arms in sorrow?
“Oh, that is the gallows where I must die,
Where I must die to-morrow.”

Oh, what hast thou done, my only son,
That thou shouldst die to-morrow?
“My life I lend to a well-loved friend
Who health of me would borrow.”

If so thou lend to a well-loved friend,
How heavy must be his sorrow!
“Ah, say not so, for well I know
I hang by his hand to-morrow.”

(The child has taken the bag of nails from REUBEN, and hands them to him, one by one, as he drives them in. One of the

nails pierces the child's palm. He bows his head over it.)

CARPENTER.—

Why, there, there, there! You've done it now!
Reuben, 'twas your fault to allow
A little child like him to play
With anything so sharp as they!

*(MARY comes forward and kneels by the child's side. She takes
his hand and tries to staunch the blood)*

Has it gone far?

MARY.—

The wound is deep.
Stay, I will bind it! See you keep
Your hand up, child. Quick, mother, bring
Yon water fresh-drawn from the spring
To wash it clean, for there was rust.

*(ANNA brings the water bowl, while REUBEN draws forward a
low bench at one end of which she sets it down)*

Maybe, upon the iron, or dust
To cause a festering in the wound.

*(MARY bathes his hand and binds it. The child closes his eyes
and sinks against her breast.)*

ANNA.—

Oh! See, he has already swooned
For loss of blood.

MARY.—

Nay, nay, 'tis sleep!
Aye! saw you not how at the leap

Of first sharp pain his face lit up,
And how he bowed as to a cup
His lips, and drained it to the lees?
So to this spirit now comes ease
And rest; for surely here he tastes
Of that dark vintage of the wastes
Whereto, for mortal need, he hastes.

CARPENTER. Strange words!

MARY.—

But stranger than all words
The peace which holds him now and herds
My lamb's life with the blessed dead.

*(She moves to lay him along the bench. ANNA spreads a cloak
across it)*

Lift off the bowl, and let his head
Rest so, even so.

CARPENTER.—

There! Let him lie
Quiet awhile. Ah! he won't die
Of that!

*(He lays his hand kindly upon his wife, then turns away. Evening
has begun to close in)*

Now, Reuben, you and I
Must stir while daylight yet allows!
This door is for the High-Priest's house,
And should already be in its place
For now Passover comes apace;
And last night they sent word to say
'Twas to be up before the day,
So that the lintel beam might bear

The blood-marks for the coming year.

MARY. Look! There are stains already there!

CARPENTER. I'll wash them off!

MARY.—

Nay, let them stay!

This blood, I trow, was shed to-day
To take some mortal's guilt away.

*(The two men have lifted the door and set it to stand against the
middle post of the doorway where it makes the form of three
crosses standing together.)*

CARPENTER.—

Soon through this door the holy feet
Of Caiaphas in service met
Shall pass each day to do God's will.

MARY.—

And, what he hath ordained, fulfill.
And some day they shall bring a Lamb
And slay, and lo, upon the jamb
And lintel of this self-same door,
Where blessed blood has been before,
More blessed blood shall then be spilt
To take from Caiaphas his guilt.

*(The men having put away their tools lift the door and carry it
away.)*

ANNA. *(Reading)* "He was taken from prison and from judgment, and who shall declare his generation? For he was cut off out of the land of the living, for the transgression of my people was he smitten. And he made his grave with the wicked, and with the rich in his death; because he had done no violence, neither was any deceit in his mouth."

(Voices of water-carriers heard without.)

1ST ANTIPHON. The bows of the mighty men are broken.

2ND ANTIPHON. And they that stumbled are girded with strength.

1ST ANTIPHON. They that were full have hired themselves for bread.

2ND ANTIPHON. And they that were hungry have ceased.

(The women pass by.)

1ST ANTIPHON. So that the barren hath born seven.

2ND ANTIPHON. And she that hath many children is waxed feeble.

1ST ANTIPHON.—

The Lord killeth, and maketh alive.

He bringeth down to the grave and bringeth up.

2ND ANTIPHON. The Lord maketh poor and maketh rich. He bringeth low and lifteth up.

MARY. It is the women going to the well.

ANNA. What are they singing?

MARY.—

Of the joy that fell,

To Anna for her first-born, Samuel.

ANNA. And thy joy also!

MARY. And the pain as well!

1ST ANTIPHON. He raiseth the poor out of the dust.

2ND ANTIPHON. And lifteth up the beggar from the dunghill.

1ST ANTIPHON. To set them among the princes.

2ND ANTIPHON. And to make them inherit the throne of glory.

1ST ANTIPHON. He will keep the feet of his saints.

2ND ANTIPHON. And the wicked shall be silent in darkness.

1ST ANTIPHON. For by strength shall no man prevail.

2ND ANTIPHON. The adversaries of the Lord shall be broken in pieces.

(The voices pass away. It begins to grow dark.)

ANNA. *(Sings as she winds her flax)*

Little child, lo, I spin
Flax to clothe thy body in;
Little child, do not grieve
Out of this a cloth I'll weave,
Make of it a little shirt,——
What man shall do thee hurt?
So while it lasts, wear it still,
What man shall wish thee ill?
Do not from thy body strip
This; 'tis human fellowship.

(She lays the cloth over the child)

MARY.—

When thou to death art bowed
This web shall be thy shroud.
So in fellowship with all
Thy soul shall meet God's call,
Oh, then, may my soul, too,
Wake and see the darkness through
And my ears, no longer bound,
List, to the heavenly sound!

(A pause. ANNA lights a small lamp. As she goes to place it in the window she stops. Its light falls on the sleeping child)

MARY.—

See, from his face has passed the pain.
And every sense of heart and brain
Is gathered unto rest again.
O son, O child, while round thy sleep

The peace of God lies folded deep,
Thou can'st not hear thy mother weep.
Oh, me, the anguish and the dread
Of that dark hour which lies ahead
When I shall see thee lying dead.
Clay, cold, and all my cares undone!
O perfect, pure, and stainless one,
My son, my own, my little son.

*(A sound of sheep passing is heard. A shepherd stops at the door,
and looks in. He draws off his hat.)*

SHEPHERD. God's peace be in this house. *(He goes on his way)*

ANNA. Again!

MARY. Who spoke?

ANNA.—

The shepherd from the plain,
The stranger, so last night he came
And stayed to greet us in God's name,
Then went.

MARY.—

And there were others, too,
Who also stayed.

(A stranger passes the door.)

STRANGER. Peace be with you!

MARY. God give you peace. *(She rises and turns)*

ANNA. Nay, he is gone.

MARY.—

Oh, strange! And more will come anon,
And each one turning from his way,
Wilt halt here at the door to say

Some word, or show by look or sign
That here peace dwells!

(Enter an old man.)

OLD MAN.—

Yes, peace is thine!
I would, I would to God, such peace were mine.

*(Enter a little child, led by its mother. The little one kneels
beside the bench where the other child is laid.)*

LITTLE CHILD.—

Gentle Jesus, meek and mild,
Look upon a little child,
Pity my simplicity,
And suffer me to come to thee!

*(The mother lifts the little one from its knees and carries it
away.)*

OLD MAN. *(Weeping, he stands in the child's place)*

I'm an old sinner, oft have I gone the road
Of mine own will, so now I bear the load;
And in my body grief has come to pass!
Surely, the preacher saith, all flesh is grass,
And goodliness the flower of the field.
Lo, the wind passeth, and its day is o'er,
And in his place man's name is known no more.
God give us peace.

*(He kneels. While he speaks others have entered. The scene has
grown dark. One of the men carries a lantern)*

1ST MAN. The grass withereth, the flower fadeth, but the word of our God
shall stand forever.

2ND MAN. Son of God, shine on us!

(All kneel.)

3RD MAN. Lamb of God, look on us!

4TH MAN. Shepherd of men, set thy sign on us!

5TH MAN. And lay thy yoke on us!

1ST MAN. And we will be thankful.

*(The moon rises. Outside the door, others are seen kneeling:
men, women and children.)*

ALL. Hail, Mary, full of Grace, the Lord is with thee! Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb: Jesus. Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners now, and at the hour of our death. Amen.

*(One by one the men rise and go out. The crowd outside also
disappears. ANNA goes and closes the doors, and the shutter
of the window. The house is flooded with moonlight. MARY
kneels at the head of the sleeping child. Voices are heard
singing.)*

VOICES.—

Ave Maria, gratia plena, Dominus tecum!
Benedicta tu in mulieribus, et Benedictus
Fructus ventris tui, Jesus!

CURTAIN.

THE WORLD'S BEST PLAYS

By Celebrated European Authors

**A NEW SERIES OF AMATEUR PLAYS BY THE BEST
AUTHORS, ANCIENT AND MODERN, ESPECIALLY
TRANSLATED WITH HISTORICAL NOTES,
SUGGESTIONS FOR STAGING, Etc., FOR THE USE OF
SCHOOLS, COLLEGES, AND DRAMATIC CLUBS**

BARRETT H. CLARK

General Editor



With the immensely increased demand for new plays for purposes of production by amateurs comes a correspondingly great demand for a careful selection of those plays which can be easily and well presented by clubs and colleges. The plays in the present series have been chosen with regard to their intrinsic value as drama and literature, and at the same time to their adaptability to the needs and limitations of such organizations.

The Series, under the personal supervision of Mr. Barrett H. Clark, instructor in the department of Dramatic Literature at Chautauqua, New York, assistant stage manager and actor with Mrs. Fiske (season 1912-1913), now comprises 44 titles, more will make their appearance during the year. Eventually there will be plays from ancient Greece and Rome, Italy, Spain, France, Russia, Germany, and the Scandinavian countries, representative of some of the best drama of all ages and lands.

Each Play is prefaced by a concise historical note by Mr. Clark and with a few suggestions for staging.

Plays Now Ready

INDIAN SUMMER, a comedy in one act by MEILHAC and HALEVY. This little play, by two of the most famous writers of comedy of the last century, has been played at the Comédie Française at Paris for upwards of forty years, and remains one of the brightest and most popular works of the period. PRICE 25 CENTS.

ROSALIE, by MAX MAUREY. A “Grand Guignol” comedy in one act, full of verve and clever dialogue. Rosalie, the stubborn maid, leads her none too amiable master and mistress into uncomfortable complications by refusing to open the front door to a supposed guest of wealth and influence. PRICE 25 CENTS.

MODESTY, by PAUL HERVIEU. A delightful trifle by one of the most celebrated of living dramatists. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE ART OF BEING BORED, (*Le Monde où l'on s'Ennuie*), a comedy in three acts by EDOUARD PAILLERON. Probably the best-known and most frequently acted comedy of manners in the realm of nineteenth century French drama. It is replete with wit and comic situations. For nearly forty years it has held the stage, while countless imitators have endeavored to reproduce its freshness and charm. PRICE 25 CENTS.

A MARRIAGE PROPOSAL, by ANTON TCHEKHOFF, a comedy in one act, by one of the greatest of modern Russian writers. This little farce is very popular in Russia, and satirizes the peasants of that country in an amusing manner. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE GREEN COAT, by ALFRED DE MUSSET and EMILE AUGIER. A slight and comic character sketch of the life of Bohemian artists in Paris, written by one of France's greatest poets and one of her best-known dramatists. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE WAGER, by GIUSEPPE GIACOSA. This one act poetic comedy, written by the most celebrated dramatist of modern Italy, was the author's first work. It treats of a wager made by a proud young page, who risks his life on the outcome of a game of chess. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE LITTLE SHEPHERDESS, a poetic comedy in one act, by ANDRE RIVOIRE. A charming pastoral sketch by a well-known French poet and

dramatist. Played with success at the Comédie Française. PRICE 25 CENTS.

PHORMIO, a Latin comedy by **TERENCE**. An up-to-date version of the famous comedy. One of the masterpieces of Latin drama: the story of a father who returns to find that his son has married a slave girl. Phormio, the parasite-villain who causes the numerous comic complications, succeeds in unraveling the difficulties, and all ends happily. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE TWINS, a Latin farce by **PLAUTUS**, upon which Shakespeare founded his Comedy of Errors. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE BOOR, by **ANTON TCHEKHOFF**. A well-known farce by the celebrated Russian master; it is concerned with Russian peasants, and portrays with masterly skill the comic side of country life. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE BLACK PEARL, by **VICTORIEN SARDOU**. One of Sardou's most famous comedies of intrigue. A house has, it is thought, been robbed. But through skilful investigation it is found that the havoc wrought has been done by lightning. PRICE 25 CENTS.

CHARMING LEANDRE, by **THEODORE DE BANVILLE**. The author of "Gringoire" is here seen in a poetic vein, yet the Frenchman's innate sense of humor recalls, in this satirical little play, the genius of Moliere. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE POST-SCRIPTUM, by **EMILE AUGIER**. Of this one-act comedy Professor Brander Matthews writes: "... one of the brightest and most brilliant little one-act comedies in any language, and to be warmly recommended to American readers." PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE HOUSE OF FOURCHAMBAULT, by **EMILE AUGIER**. One of the greatest of recent French family dramas. Although the play is serious in tone, it contains touches which entitle it to a position among the best comedies of manners of the times. PRICE 50 CENTS.

MASTER PATELIN, SOLICITOR, a comedy in three acts. Special version by **BRUEYS**. One of the most famous of early French farces. The setting and character belong to the late Middle Ages. The play is concerned with the crooked dealings of a clever lawyer. 7 men, 2 women. PRICE 25 CENTS.

CRISPIN, HIS MASTER'S RIVAL, a comedy in one act by LE SAGE. A famous comedy by the author of "Gil Blas," concerned with the pranks of two clever valets. 18th century costumes and settings. 4 men, 3 women. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE LEGACY, a comedy in one act by MARIVAUX. A delicate high comedy of intrigue. Marivaux one of the masters of old French comedy, and this play is full of deft touches of characterization. 2 women, 4 men. PRICE 25 CENTS.

AFTER THE HONEYMOON, a farce in one act by WOLFGANG GYALUI. A Hungarian farce full of brilliant dialogue and movement. 1 man, 1 woman. PRICE 25 CENTS.

A CHRISTMAS TALE, a poetic play by MAURICE BOUCHOR. A beautiful little miracle play of love and devotion, laid in 15th century Paris. 2 men, 2 women. PRICE 25 CENTS.

CRAINQUEBILLE, a play in three scenes by ANATOLE FRANCE. A delightful series of pictures of Parisian street life, by the author of "The Man Who Married a Dumb Wife." 12 men, 6 women. PRICE 25 CENTS.

JEAN-MARIE, a poetic play in one act by ANDRE THEURIET. A pathetic play of Norman peasant life. 2 men, 1 woman. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE REBOUND, a comedy in one act by L. B. PICARD. A clever comedy of intrigue, and a satire of social position. 2 women, 5 men. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE DOCTOR IN SPITE OF HIMSELF, by MOLIERE. A famous farce by the greatest of French dramatists. Sganarelle has to be beaten before he will acknowledge that he is a doctor, which he is not. He then works apparently miraculous cures. The play is a sharp satire on the medical profession in the 17th Century. PRICE 25 CENTS.

BRIGNOL AND HIS DAUGHTER, by CAPUS. The first comedy in English of the most sprightly and satirical of present-day French dramatists. PRICE 50 CENTS.

CHOOSING A CAREER, by G. A. DE CAILLAVET. Written by one of the authors of "Love Watches." A farce of mistaken identity, full of humorous situations and bright lines. PRICE 25 CENTS.

FRENCH WITHOUT A MASTER, by TRISTAN BERNARD. A clever farce by one of the most successful of French dramatists. It is concerned with the difficulties of a bogus-interpreter who does not know a word of French. PRICE 25 CENTS.

PATER NOSTER, a poetic play in one act, by FRANCOIS COPPEE. A pathetic incident of the time of the Paris Commune, in 1871. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE ROMANCERS, a comedy in three acts, by EDMOND ROSTAND. New translation of this celebrated and charming little romantic play by the famous author of "Cyrano de Bergerac" and "Chantecler." PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE MERCHANT GENTLEMAN (Le Bourgeois Gentil-homme), by MOLIERE. New translation of one of Moliere's comic masterpieces, a play which is peculiarly well adapted to amateur production. PRICE 50 CENTS.

THE HOUSE OF FOURCHAMBAULT, by EMILE AUGIER. One of the greatest of recent French family dramas. Although the play is serious in tone, it contains touches which entitle it to a position among the best comedies of manners of the times. PRICE 50 CENTS.

PANURGE'S SHEEP, a comedy in one Act by MEILHAC and HALEVY. A famous and often-acted little play based upon the obstinacy of a charming woman, who is finally induced to marry. 1 man, 2 women. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE LAW-SUIT, (Der Prozess), a comedy in one act by RODERICH BENEDIX. A famous comedy by the well-known German-dramatist—author of "The Obstinate Family," and "The Third Man." The play is full of amusing situations and bright lines. 5 men. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE THIRD MAN (Der Dritte), a comedy in one act by RODERICH BENEDIX. A highly amusing little comedy based upon the obstinacy of human beings, and proves the truth of the saying that "love finds a way." 3 women, 1 man. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE GENTLEMAN TRADESMAN (Le Bourgeois Gentil-homme), a comedy in four acts by MOLIERE. One of the best-known comedies of the celebrated master of comedy. "The Gentleman Tradesman" ridicules the affectations of M. Jourdain, a rich parvenu. 9 men, 5 women. PRICE 50 CENTS.

THE SICILIAN (Le Sicilien), a farce in two scenes by MOLIERE. One of the lighter comedies of intrigue. This play is laid in Sicily, and has to do with the capture of a beautiful Greek slave from her selfish and tyrannical master. 4 men, 3 women. PRICE 25 CENTS.

DOCTOR LOVE (L'Amour Medecin), a farce in three acts by MOLIERE. An uproarious farce, satirizing the medical profession. Through it runs the story of a young girl who pretends to be ill in order that she may marry the man she loves. 5 men, 4 women. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE AFFECTED YOUNG LADIES (Les Precieuses Ridicules), a comedy in one act by MOLIERE. The famous satire on intellectual and social affectation. Like most of Moliere's plays, the theme in this is ever modern. 3 women, 6 men. PRICE 25 CENTS.

I'M GOING! A comedy in one act by TRISTAN BERNARD. A delightful bit of comedy of obstinacy and reconciliation. 1 man, 1 woman. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE FAIRY (La Fee), a romantic comedy in one act by OCTAVE FEUILLET. Laid in a hut in Normandy, this little comedy is full of poetic charm and quiet humor. The element of the supernatural is introduced in order to drive home a strong lesson. 1 woman, 3 men. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE VILLAGE (Le Village), a comedy in one act by OCTAVE FEUILLET. The author here paints the picture of an elderly couple, and shows that they have not realized their happiness until it is on the point of being taken from them. 2 women, 2 men. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE BENEFICENT BEAR, a comedy in three acts, by GOLDONI. One of the best-known comedies of the Father of Italian Comedy. A costume piece laid in 18th century France, the principal character in which is a good-hearted, though gruff, old uncle. 4 men, 3 women. PRICE 25 CENTS.

GRAMMAR (La Grammaire), a farce in one act by LABICHE. An amusing and charming comedy by one of the greatest of 19th century French dramatists. 4 men, 1 woman. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE TWO COWARDS (Les Deux Timides), a comedy in one act by LABICHE. A very amusing and human little comedy, in which a strong-willed girl helps her father choose for her the man she wishes to marry. 2 women, 3 men. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE DOCTOR IN SPITE OF HIMSELF, by MOLIERE. A famous farce by the greatest of French dramatists. Sganarelle has to be beaten before he will acknowledge that he is a doctor, which he is not. He then works apparently miraculous cures. The play is a sharp satire on the medical profession in the 17th Century. PRICE 25 CENTS.

BRIGNOL AND HIS DAUGHTER, by CAPUS. The first comedy in English of the most sprightly and satirical of present-day French dramatists. PRICE 50 CENTS.

CHOOSING A CAREER, by G. A. DE CAILLAVET. Written by one of the authors of "Love Watches." A farce of mistaken identity, full of humorous situations and bright lines. PRICE 25 CENTS.

FRENCH WITHOUT A MASTER, by TRISTAN BERNARD. A clever farce by one of the most successful of French dramatists. It is concerned with the difficulties of a bogus-interpreter who does not know a word of French. PRICE 25 CENTS.

PATER NOSTER, a poetic play in one act, by FRANCOIS COPPEE. A pathetic incident of the time of the Paris Commune, in 1871. PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE ROMANCERS, a comedy in three acts, by EDMOND ROSTAND. New translation of this celebrated and charming little romantic play by the famous author of "Cyrano de Bergerac" and "Chantecler." PRICE 25 CENTS.

THE MERCHANT GENTLEMAN, (Le Bourgeois Gentil-homme), by MOLIERE. New translation of one of Moliere's comic masterpieces, a play which is peculiarly well adapted to amateur production. PRICE 50 CENTS.

Transcriber's note

Obvious typographical errors have been corrected. All other inconsistencies are as in the original.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK NAZARETH: A
MORALITY IN ONE ACT ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the

collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with

this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official

version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, “Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation.”
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.

- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES

EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a)

distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact

links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility: www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.